

MotionBuilder is one of the most popular 3D character animation building software developed by Autodesk. Essential features of MotionBuilder include motion capture, keyframe animation, ragdoll physics, facial and skeletal animation, etc, for all the multimedia projects in games, films, and television.

Earlier, it was known as Filmbox owned by Kaydara, a Canadian company. And later it was overtaken by the Alias organisation, which renamed the software to MotionBuilder. Autodesk then acquired MotionBuilder to run its current market ownership.



AutoDesk MotionBuilder

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Understanding the MotionBuilder Workflows

We will be looking at two ways to go about this, using a workflow that integrates with other Autodesk software, and a generic workflow. Users should use Autodesk interoperability workflow for projects that allow ease of communication between MotionBuilder and 3ds Max, or MotionBuilder and Maya.

While for the files or projects built with pre-2012 versions of Autodesk Maya and 3ds Max, users should use generic workflows or any other third party 3D software package to get optimum results. Let us look at a brief explanation for these two MotionBuilder workflows.

1. Autodesk interoperability workflow

Users can choose from menu options to either 'File Send To Maya' or 'File Send To 3ds Max' to get specific files.

- For the 3ds Max, the interoperability process follows these strategic points.
 - i. Starting by first creating a model in 3ds max and forwarding it to the MotionBuilder.
 - ii. Then you load character models in the MotionBuilder, prepare the model and add animation for moving further.
 - iii. Now use a control rig to add more animation to your character. The control rig is a very useful animation tool that can be used to build, position, and control your character's features.
 - iv. You can add more support for your character with any additional parts or extensions.
 - v. Build your animation for the character with keyframes and features.